

CDN Incident Alert: 0098. TLP: CLEAR**Date**

Title	CZ	Sputnik continuation NeČT24 created a new Facebook page ahead of the Czech elections	03/10/2025
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Summary

- On August 29th, the Russian-affiliated media entity NeČT24 created a Facebook page.
- NeČT24 likely created the channel to boost their reach during the Czech elections, circumventing sanctions against Sputnik.
- The operation promoted the narrative that Russia is a better ally to Czechia than the West and that mainstream media cannot be trusted.
- The new Facebook page has already accumulated over 2,400 followers. While the content being posted mirrors that of its other channels, it may allow them to reach a new audience.
- The page is circumventing sanctions on Sputnik by rebranding and positioning itself as an independent media to smear their political opponents by discrediting their public image.

Incident

The Russian state-owned media agency “Sputnik” began [operating](#) in Czechia in March 2015 under the name “Czech Sputnik”. It served to disseminate anti-Western narratives in Czechia until its website and social media channels were finally blocked following European sanctions on March 1st 2022.

Shortly after, on March 17th 2022, the Sputnik website [published](#) a notice in response to the sanctions informing readers of the creation of a new [Telegram](#) channel named “NeČT24” aimed at bypassing Western sanctions. The Telegram channel, still active today, now counts over 30,000 subscribers. Its associated website, [42tcen\[.com\]](#) has now effectively allowed “Czech Sputnik” to pursue its activities under a new name. The Ministry of the Interior of the Czech Republic [published](#) an article confirming that “This effectively shifted the role of Sputnik to the newly created 42TČen website and the associated NeČT24 Telegram channel”.

In the past months, NeČT24 has been actively [promoting](#) pro-Russian candidates in the run-up to the 2025 Czech parliamentary election. Daniel Sterzik, chairman of the Stačilo! Movement has a [regular column](#) on the website. NeČT24 also has a history of publishing [deepfake](#) and [edited videos](#) to push their narrative.

The organisation has maintained an active social media presence on Telegram since its inception and [X](#) (formerly Twitter) since March 2023. On August [29th](#), a new official [Facebook](#) account was created. This new page is very active, averaging multiple posts a day and has already accumulated over 2,400 followers. The content being posted on the platform mirrors that of its other channels: mainly revolving around pro-Russian and anti-Western narratives.

This Facebook account constitutes a new vector of influence for Russian state-sponsored operations in Czechia. The risk is further exacerbated by the proximity of the upcoming Czech elections. A sample of their followers shows that the Facebook page is followed by real Czech [users](#). The assessment is based on creation dates, profile pictures, and the content they are posting.

Systemic violation assessment

- I. Why it's a risk: The neČT24 platform, along with its newly launched Facebook page, poses the significant risk of facilitating Russian influence within the country's public discourse.
- II. a. neČT24 actively creates and spreads fabricated content to push their narratives.
 - b. The platform is manipulating users by posing as a local news agency despite being the successor of Czech Sputnik, a Russian state-owned agency.

III. Potential illegality: neČT24 serves as the replacement for Czech Sputnik, an actor who has already been sanctioned by the EU. As such, it may be subject to the same sanctions.

Narrative

Meta-narrative 1: Russia is a better ally to Czechia than Western countries.

Sub-narrative 1: Russia promotes traditional values.

Sub-narrative 2: The West is corrupt and will push “dangerous” ideologies (LGBT, immigration)

Meta-narrative 2: Mainstream media cannot be trusted.

Sub-narrative 1: Mainstream media is corrupted by the West.

Sub-narrative 2: Only neČT24 will publish real news that mainstream media doesn't want the general public to know.

Impact and Outcome

Reach: NeČT24 has accumulated over 2,400 followers on Facebook, 33,000 on Telegram and 2,400 on X. The site has also platformed pro-Russian politicians such as Daniel Sterzik, thus allowing them to increase their voter base.

Outcome: NeČT24's new Facebook page allows them to access an older and less technologically literate viewer base, potentially affecting the outcome of the upcoming elections.

Key Objectives and Behaviours

Objective 1: [T0002 Facilitate State Propaganda](#) - An outlet in Czechia in favour of Russian objectives.

Objective 2: [T0135.001 Smear](#) - The outlet smears political opponents by discrediting their public image. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky is also a frequent target.

[T0095: Develop Owned Media Assets](#) - NeČT24 created a new Facebook page.

[T0097.202: News Outlet Persona](#) - The platform presents as independent despite being tied to the Russian state.

[T0121.001: Bypass Content Blocking](#) - The platform is bypassing European sanctions by presenting under a different brand.

[T0129.001: Conceal Network Identity](#) - The entity is hiding its affiliation with Sputnik News.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions Taken: Alongside this alert, we reported neČT24's new Facebook page and other social media accounts to their respective platforms.

Recommendations: Given that neČT24 operates as the successor to Czech Sputnik, effectively continuing its operations and influence, we recommend that it be considered for inclusion in the EU-sanctioned entities list to ensure continuity in the enforcement of existing measures.

Report	Threat Actor	Authors	Platforms	FIMI assessment
N/A	Russia	Ewan Casandjin, Saman Nazari, Alliance4Europe	X, Facebook, Telegram	High